

update_readme_doc_links.sh — companion guide

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-15T16:30:00Z **Authority:** §11.4.18 (script documentation) · §11.4.57 (README doc-link section) · §11.4.44 (revision header) · §11.4.67 (target-shell parseability)

Overview

scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh renders the §11.4.57 “Tracked-Items + Status Documents” section into README.md. It discovers the canonical tracked documents, reads each one’s §11.4.44 header fields (**Revision:** and **Last modified:**), and rewrites the markdown table between the section markers. Only the marked region changes; the rest of README.md is preserved verbatim.

Prerequisites

- POSIX sh, awk, sed, grep, find, git, coreutils. No network.
- README.md MUST already contain both section markers:
 - <!-- doc-link-section:begin -->
 - <!-- doc-link-section:end --> The script aborts (exit 3) if either is absent — it never invents the section.

Usage

```
scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh          # rewrites
<repo-root>/README.md
scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh path/to/README.md
```

Exit codes: 0 success · 2 README not found · 3 markers missing.

What it links

Linked ONLY when the file actually exists (§11.4.6 — no fabricated rows):

- docs/Issues.md, docs/Issues_Summary.md (§11.4.12 / §11.4.15 / §11.4.16)
- docs/Fixed.md, docs/Fixed_Summary.md (§11.4.19 / §11.4.53)
- docs/CONTINUATION.md (§12.10)
- every docs/**/Status.md (auto-discovered via `find docs -name Status.md`) and its sibling Status_Summary.md (§11.4.45 / §11.4.56) — this

includes docs/features/Status.md + docs/features/
Status_Summary.md.

Columns: Document | Last modified | Revision | Markdown | HTML | PDF. A DOCX column is added automatically when at least one linked doc has a tracked .docx sibling (the §11.4.153 four-format Feature-Status class). Per-row format cells that have no on-disk sibling render –, never a broken link.

Edge cases

- A doc with no §11.4.44 header renders – for Revision / Last modified rather than failing (honest absence, §11.4.6).
- Status docs are sorted by path (LC_ALL=C sort) for deterministic, idempotent output (§11.4.50 / §11.4.86) — re-running with no doc changes yields no diff.
- The DOCX column appears for the whole table (not per-row) so alignment stays uniform; rows without a .docx show –.

Internal behaviour

1. Resolve repo root via `git rev-parse --show-toplevel` (fallback: two levels up).
2. Build an ordered candidate list (root canonical set, then discovered Status pairs) into a temp file; skip non-existent files.
3. Decide whether to emit the DOCX column.
4. Extract header fields with `awk` (scoped to the first 40 lines).
5. Render the section body to a temp file, then splice it between the markers with `awk` (no in-place `sed` dialect risk), and write back to `README.md`.

Related scripts

- `scripts/testing/generate_issues_summary.sh` — Issues_Summary generator.
- `scripts/testing/generate_fixed_summary.sh` — Fixed_Summary generator.
- The §11.4.59 README export refresh (pandoc HTML + weasyprint PDF) is run by the caller after this script so `README.html` / `README.pdf` stay in sync.

Last verified

- 2026-06-15 — `sh -n + bash -n` clean; generator run populated the README section with 7 doc rows (Issues, Issues Summary, Fixed, Fixed Summary, CONTINUATION, features Status, features Status Summary) and re-run was a no-op diff (idempotent).